

Oppo Enco Air3

Hold their ground firmly

The Oppo Enco Air3, with an MRP of ₹5,999, are competing in the tightly packed mid-range segment of the TWS market. We got a pair of these earbuds at the Digit Test Centre for review. And, here's what we found out.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The case of the Oppo Enco Air3 looks great at first sight. It has a dual-tone finish. When you flip the case around, you see a lot of text. On the case, we also get to see a USB-C type port. The earbuds also sport a really subtle dual-tone finish. There are touch controls on the top of the stem and contact pads for chargin on the inside. The lobe of the earbuds has a half-in-ear design. As we have always maintained, we are not fans of the half-in-ear design on earbuds. This is because whenever a bud comes with this design, the chance of it fitting perfectly in different people's ears drops by a lot, affecting the performance as well. We weren't big fans of the glossy finish on the buds and the case, just because of the scratches it tends to pick up over time.

FEATURES

Coming to the features of the Oppo Enco Air3, the first one that caught our eye was the Cadence HiFi5 DSP (Digital Signal Processor) that these earbuds come with. In our testing, we found that the earbuds did not sound bad. If you are in a closed space, like an office, these earbuds would make for a great calling companion. But, in extremely noisy environments, such as on the road, with a lot of noise around you, some problems might creep in. Oppo Active Audio was another feature highlighted by the brand. In our testing, we noticed the presence of this feature. With a decent fit, as was the case with the reviewer, these earbuds did not sound completely hollow. Again, it did not work wonders, suddenly pushing it to the level of top-of-the-line



earbuds. But it did bring back some lost character from the sound. By tapping the stem, you can change the tracks and volume levels of the earbuds, but you cannot play or pause music. Basic play and pause functionality on earbuds is a necessity, and this seems like a massive oversight.

PERFORMANCE

In terms of performance, the first few tracks that we listened to and the output that we got when testing the performance of these earbuds sounded decent. Compared to the response of the Pink Noise, which is our benchmark, the earbuds fared decently well. They hold their ground. We see that there is a boost in the low frequencies, up to the 125 Hz mark, where the graph starts to drop down. As it approaches the mid frequencies, it comes pretty close to the Pink Noise response, which is our benchmark, before spiking in the higher frequencies. In tracks like UpTown Funk, we noticed that the bass was not muddy and not completely lost, either. However, because of the spikes that are noticed in the high frequencies, the earbuds were able to produce vocals with some amount of clarity in tracks like

Rescue Me by One Republic. In terms of the microphone performance, the audio quality in our tests met the expectations that we set for earbuds in this price range.

BATTERY

The battery on the Oppo Enco Air3, in our tests, lasted five and a half hours, in contrast to the company's claims of six hours. And the case provided for about four more charges, with some juice left over, bringing the total battery life of the earbuds to 22 hours. As for the consistency of the battery drain on both earbuds, it was the same for the most part. There was a difference of a per cent or two in battery levels.

VERDICT

Oppo Enco Air3 make for a decent pair of earbuds. However, the space that they are competing in is densely packed with competitors that match or exceed the performance and features of these earbuds. When pitched against the like of the OnePlus Nord Buds, and their CE variant, these earbuds hold their ground. They have their own

flaws, but overall are a decent package for people to put their money into. If you are looking for a half-in-ear experience, then the other earbuds that you can look at are the Nothing Ear (Stick), which are slightly more expensive than these. In the same price range, you will find the OnePlus Nord Buds CE, which are in essence, their direct competitors.

—Sativik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Driver: 13.4mm Dynamic unit | Frequency response range: 20Hz ~ 20kHz | Bluetooth codec: AAC / SBC | Bluetooth version: BT 5.3 | Battery type: Rechargeable lithium battery | Battery capacity: 27mAh(earbuds)/300mAh(charging case) | Playtime: 6h (single charge), 25h (with charging case) | Charging time: 1.2h (earbuds); 2h (earbuds + charging case) | Charging input: USB Type-C | Water resistance (earbuds): IP54 | Weight: 3.75g (earbud), 37.4g (Earbuds+Charging case)

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